Ford Motor Company

November 2000

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 00S39: Certain 2000 – 2001 Model Year Lincoln LS – Front Suspension Lower Ball Joints

REF: Dealer Announcement dated December 17, 1998, Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure (Attachment IV)

AFFECTED VEHICLES

- Certain 2000 Lincoln LS vehicles built at the Wixom Assembly Plant from Job #1 2000 through Job End 2000.
- Certain 2001 Lincoln LS vehicles built at the Wixom Assembly Plant from Job #1 2001 through September 29, 2000.

SAFETY CONCERN

Some of the affected vehicles may have an under-torque condition of the front suspension lower ball joint attaching nut. An under-torque condition may result in loosening of the attaching nut.

In some cases this can result in a fracture of the ball stud, which may lead to a separation of the lower control arm from the steering knuckle. This could reduce steering control and, when occurring on the left hand side, could potentially damage the fuel lines and/or fuel filter, resulting in a fuel leak.

SERVICE ACTION

Before demonstrating or delivering any of the vehicles involved in this recall, the dealer must inspect the torque of both ball stud-attaching nuts (STOCK UNITS AND/OR VEHICLES WITH LESS THAN 15 MILES WILL ONLY NEED TO BE RETORQUED TO SPECIFICATIONS AS OUTLINED IN ATTACHMENT III).

Less than 2% of the total involved units in this program are expected to be out of the recommended specifications outlined in Attachment III. Only these vehicles will require any parts replacement.

If both ball studs are within specifications as stated in Attachment III, the vehicle may be released to the customer, or delivered.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $1,100 per vehicle.

LINCOLN COMMITMENT SPECIAL HANDLING PROCEDURE

The Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure has been activated for all Lincoln owners affected by this recall. Please see dealer announcement dated December 17, 1998, Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure (Attachment IV). The special handling procedure provides additional allowance to enable dealers to offer Lincoln owners convenient vehicle handling.

Lincoln Mercury is asking for your support and the cooperation of your sales and service teams to make this a positive experience for our Lincoln LS customers, many of whom are new to the Lincoln family.

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information
Attachment IV: Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure Announcement Letter
Customer Notification Letter

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information:……...1-800-423-8851
Other (Dealer Only) Recall Questions:……...1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 00S39
Certain 2000 – 2001 Model Year Lincoln LS
Front Suspension Lower Ball Joints

OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer VIN list which you will receive in the Ford Dealer Consolidated Communicator (FDCC). Also, correct other eligible vehicles which are brought to your dealership.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Immediately contact any affected owner whose name is not on the list. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date.

Note: Owners should receive the " Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure". Before calling Lincoln LS owners, review Attachment IV to familiarize yourself with this special handling procedure.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.
- To claim for the "Lincoln Commitment Special Handling", follow the instructions on page two of Attachment IV.

OWNER REFUNDS

Ford Motor Company will only refund owner-paid repairs for front suspension lower ball joints made before the date of the Owner Letter (or after the date of the Owner Letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer). Refer to ACESII manual for refund information.

RENTAL CARS

Rental vehicles are approved per guidelines in "Lincoln Commitment Special Handling", Attachment IV.

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Front Suspension Lower Ball Joints

LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time
Inspect Torque on Both Lower Ball Joints	00S39A	0.3 Hours
Inspect Torque on Both Lower Ball Joints and Replace One Knuckle (includes check/adjust toe)	00S39B	1.2 Hours
Inspect Torque on Both Lower Ball Joints and Replace Both Knuckles (includes check/adjust toe)	00S39C	1.6 Hours
Administrative Allowance	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN"	0.1 Hour
Lincoln Commitment Special Handling*	Misc. Expense Code "LCHP"	See Attachment IV

* Lincoln Commitment Special Handling does not apply to vehicles in dealer stock.

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information

Parts will not be direct shipped for this recall. Less than 2% of involved units are expected to require parts. Order parts through the Recall Hotline at 1-800-248-0186.

Stock, Interim, and Emergency Orders	First 30 days after launch	Call 1-800-248-0186
All Orders	31 days after launch	Normal order process

Part Number	Description	Quantity
1W4Z-3C320-RH	Right Hand Knuckle Kit	1
1W4Z-3C320-LH	Left Hand Knuckle Kit	1

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DOR/COR Information:

DOR/COR number 50195 identifies parts ordered for this campaign through the Recall Hotline 1-800-248-0186.

DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to:

- DOES II
- Updated Price Book

EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

Program Announcement Letter
Lincoln Commitment Special Handling

Ford Customer Service Division

Ford Motor Company
P.O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121

December 17, 1998

To: All Lincoln Mercury and Ford Dealers

cc: Parts Managers
Service Managers

Subject: Announcing Lincoln Commitment Special Customer Handling Procedure for Certain Recalls and Owner Notification Programs

As part of our ongoing commitment to Lincoln customers, we are pleased to announce the Lincoln Commitment Special Customer Handling Procedure to provide additional dealer compensation for certain Recalls and Owner Notification Programs(ONP's) that affect Lincoln brand vehicles.

This additional compensation is being provided to allow dealers to provide personalized service designed to make the recall repair a positive experience for the Lincoln customer, many of whom are new to the Lincoln family.

Each Recall/ONP Bulletin affecting Lincoln vehicles will indicate whether the Lincoln Commitment Special Customer Handling Procedure is authorized; please note that not every Recall/ONP will qualify for this procedure and that the procedure will not be communicated to customers as a normal benefit of the Lincoln Commitment Program. Special handling and claiming instructions are included on the attached page. This program will apply only to Lincoln vehicles which have been delivered to customers.

We ask you to make maximum usage of these special enhancements to the Lincoln Commitment Program when applicable. Thank you in advance for your support of this program and our commitment to surprise and delight our Lincoln customers.

/O.S.B./
Mark Hutchins
President
Lincoln Mercury

/O.S.B./
M. D. Jordan
Executive Director
Ford Customer Service Division
North America

If Dealer Picks up and Returns Vehicle for Customer:

Special Service	Dealer Compensation	Claim Procedure
• Pick up the customer's vehicle (at a location of their preference such as home or place of business) and return after repair* • Drop off comparable loaner vehicle • Refill fuel tank • Wash and vacuum vehicle • Return vehicle to customer after repair is completed	Up to 2 hours additional labor (converted to a dollar amount) plus actual cost of fuel and wash/vacuum Note: Labor time to fill tank and wash/vacuum has been included in 2 hour allowance Labor subject to time recording procedures as outlined in Warranty & Policy Manual	Submit total dollar value (labor+fuel+wash/vacuum) using Misc. Expense Code "LCHP" EXAMPLE (using example labor rate of $58/hour and fuel cost of $1.05/gallon): 1.2 hrs. labor* = $69.60 9.0 gals fuel = 9.45 Wash/vacuum = 3.50 Total Submitted = $82.55 *travel time+fueling/washing labor
Provide comparable loaner vehicle to customer when vehicle is picked up	Actual cost up to a maximum of $35 per day for a Lincoln loaner or up to $28 per day for a Mercury or Ford loaner (This does not count against TAP allocation)	Submit up to 3 days maximum using "LOANER" (if additional days are required, call 1-800-325-5621 for authorization)
Perform Recall/ONP repair at dealership	Inspection/repair labor allowance as specified in Recall/ONP Bulletin	See applicable Recall/ONP Bulletin

*Or repair on-site if appropriate; if on-site repair is performed, rental charges do not apply.

If Customer Brings Vehicle to Dealer:

Special Service	Dealer Compensation	Claim Procedure
Perform Recall/ONP repair at dealership	Inspection/repair labor allowance as specified in Recall/ONP Bulletin	See applicable Recall/ONP Bulletin
Provide comparable loaner vehicle to customer	Actual cost up to a maximum of $35 per day for a Lincoln loaner or up to $28 per day for a Mercury or Ford loaner (This does not count against TAP allocation)	Submit up to 3 days maximum using "LOANER" (if additional days are required, call 1-800-325-5621 for authorization)
Refill fuel tank and wash/ vacuum vehicle	Up to 0.5 hour additional labor (converted to a dollar amount) plus actual cost of fuel and wash/vacuum	Submit total dollar value (labor+fuel+wash/vacuum) using Misc. Expense Code "LCHP"

Ford Motor Company

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121
1-800-392-3673

November 2000

00S39

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

This notice is sent to you in accordance with the requirements of the National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act.

Ford Motor Company has determined that a defect which relates to motor vehicle safety exists in certain 2000 – 2001 Model Year Lincoln LS vehicles.

We apologize for this inconvenience and want to assure you that we are dedicated to maintaining your Lincoln LS as an exceptional vehicle. Our commitment, together with your dealer, is to provide you with the highest level of service and support possible.

What the safety issue is …

Some of the affected vehicles may have an under-torque condition of the front suspension lower ball joint attaching nut. An under-torque condition may result in loosening of the attaching nut.

In some cases, this can result in a fracture of the ball stud, which may lead to a separation of the lower control arm from the knuckle. This could reduce steering control and, when occurring on the left hand side, could potentially damage the fuel lines and/or fuel filter, resulting in a fuel leak.

What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do ...

The dealer must inspect the torque of both front suspension lower ball stud-attaching nuts of your vehicle. In the unlikely event that they are found to be out of the recommended specifications, the steering knuckle and ball joint assembly will to be replaced.

Ford Motor Company will repair your vehicle free of charge (parts and labor). Owners who are affected by this recall are requested to return their vehicle to their dealer to have this service performed.

How long will it take?

The time needed for this repair is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling issues, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time.

What we are asking you to do …

Call your dealer without delay. Ask for a service date for Safety Recall 00S39.

When you bring your vehicle in, show the dealer this letter. If you misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.

If you've already paid for this service …

If you paid to have this service done before the date of this letter, Ford is offering a full refund. For the refund, please give your paid original receipt to your dealer. To avoid delays, do not send receipts to Ford Motor Company.

If you've changed address or sold the vehicle …

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us if you have changed address or sold the vehicle.

If you have concerns …

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact your dealership's Service Manager. If you still need assistance, please contact the Lincoln Customer Relationship Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

CALL: (800) 521-4140
(800) 232-5952 (TDD for the Hearing Impaired)

Office Hours: (Eastern Standard Time)

Monday-Friday: 8am - 11pm
Saturday: 9am - 6pm

or you may contact us through the Internet at:
www.ownerconnection.com
Our current response time to Internet inquiries is three business days.

You also may send a complaint to the Administrator, National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, 400 Seventh Street, S. W., Washington, D. C. 20590 or call the toll free Auto Safety Hotline 1-800-424-9393 or 1-888-327-4863.

Quality Care service is there for you all year round.

QualityCare™ at your service

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we're here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company for automotive products and services. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs